

AETHYRS

2016

The concept of aethyrs as depicted most famously in "The Vision and the Voice" by Aleister Crowley implies a specific cosmological model for the transcendental nature of the soul. Crowley offers a feeble and somewhat inconsistent explanation of this model in the introduction to the book. The following is an effort to reconcile those inconsistencies and offer an internally-consistent model for understanding the concept of aethyrs.

There are 30 aethyrs. Each aethyr corresponds to one of the 3 triads of sephiroth in the Qabalistic Tree of Life. Further, each aethyr is home to 3 angels which represent the individual sephiroth in the corresponding triad.

The first, or lowest, aethyr is the 30th. It is unique in that it has 4 angels ascribed to it. This is to account for Malkuth. Subsequently, the 29th and 28th aethyrs complete the Tree.

In order to accommodate 30 aethyrs, this model envisions 10 Trees stacked on top of one another. The relationship between each of the Trees describes a transcendental model of divine emanation. In this way, every third aethyr is connected in the sense that each third lower-

numbered aethyr represents a greater level of abstraction or a deeper level of understanding of the same essential concept.

This stands in rather stark contrast to the more traditional model of a single tree which represents emanation from Kether to Malkuth. However this additional dimension of complexity offers an opportunity to understand the triads of the Tree as distinctly separate states of being, rather than representing abstractions of one another. In this way, there is dramatically more "room" in the model to describe a much wider range of spiritual conditions.

As we move to the 27th aethyr, the completed tree collapses into the Malkuth of a new Tree. With Malkuth now accounted for, the next three aethyrs each contain three angels. In this way, we now have a total of 19 angels: Ten were ascribed to the first tree and 9 were ascribed to the second with the 27th, 26th, and 25th aethyrs.

In this way, the total number of angels is:

$$10 \text{ (Trees)} \times 9 \text{ (angels / Tree)} + 1 \text{ (the first Malkuth)} = 91$$

According to the attributions of Hebrew gematria, 91 is also the value of the word 'Amen'.

That's it. Now let's try a quick validation of this model. To make things a bit easier, let's allow the triad numbers to count down from the Supernals(1) to the Man of Earth(3) in order to match the order in which the aethyrs are assigned.

We know that the 8th aethyr pertains to the HGA, which is associated with Tiphareth, which is in the Lovers(2) triad of the tree. Using this model, we can remove two trees ($2 \times 3 = 6$) before we are left with only the tree that contains the desired aethyr. Subtracting those trees gives:

$$. \text{ } ^{\circ} \text{ } \diamond \text{ } ^{\circ} \text{ } + \text{ } \text{---} \text{ } 46 \text{ } \text{---} \text{ } + \text{ } \diamond \text{ } ^{\circ} \text{ } .$$

8-6=2. Which is the right answer.

If that proof made you feel like a nun was about to swat your fingers,
here's the actual formula in all its glory:

$$\text{Triad} = ((\text{Aethyr} - 1) \% 3) + 1$$

h/t Frater Achad⁴⁰

⁴⁰ This essay was inspired by *The Anatomy of the Body of God* by Frater Achad